New Zealand Rogaining Association (Inc) **22nd September 2003**
http://www.rogaine.org.nz/

NZRA Newsletter - September 2003

President's Piece

NZRA has now officially been in existence for 15 months. The large number of participants from non-orienteering backgrounds supports our belief that the two disciplines are distinct, though similar. We have run the first New Zealand championship since February 2000, and although the number of participants was below expectation at about 100, the quality of the field represented most of New Zealand's best. We have established an expectation that there will now be a NZ championship on an annual basis and we will ensure that this occurs.

Our structure of supporting rogaines which are not directly run by the Association is proving to be a successful formula. Bruce McLeod's E.P.I.C. events are going from strength to strength, and Chris Forne is actively pursuing local events in Canterbury under this framework. With Chris's experience in organizing TWALKs, watch this spot. We are also getting strong support in Dunedin, and you will see some good events coming from there in the future.

We are looking for more entrepreneurs to try their hand in organising an event. The main requirement is getting access to land in your area at the time you want to have an event. If you have been thinking vaguely of putting on an event somewhere, but aren't sure where to start, contact us. Alternatively, if you are keen to learn a bit by helping out with a coming event, contact us or the event organiser. There are many administrative things you can do to help without jeopardizing your right to compete – that is, you get to help *and* compete.

The recent prosecution of a sports organizer is of great concern to us all. Grant Hunter is leading the preparation of a standardized safety procedure for our use, which will establish what we believe to be a sensible and accepted protocol. We emphasize that people compete at their own risk, and that the general public and animals have as much right as we do to be there. However as organizers we must ensure that competitors are aware of their responsibilities to others and to themselves, and are expected to be competent and equipped for the terrain and weather.

Pete Squires

Recent Events

The two most recent rogaines were held at opposite ends of the country and each had about 170 participants.

The Montrail Rock and Pillar EPIC – 6th September

This 12hr event was organised by Bruce McLeod in an historic area of Central Otago beneath, and on, the Rock and Pillar range. As with all Bruce's events the checkpoints were identified by a word on a 12cm x 6cm rectangle of plastic, rather than the standard rogaining flag, and the clues were cryptic puzzles instead of the usual plain, boring "bend in creek", "saddle", "hilltop" or "small gully". The winning team was "Wondering Allowed" of Angus Jennings, Martin Lukes, and Keith Murray – they seemed to run everywhere all day. See results on Bruce's website http://homepages.ihug.co.nz/~Sbmcleod/Resultsframes.htm and impressions from Pete Squires at http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main_files/results/RockandPillar2003.htm

Multisport Bikes Cascades Rogaine – 9th August
Phil Wood and Shaun Collins have organised two rogaines in the Waitakere Ranges (Auckland) so far this year. See the Lactic Turkey website http://www.lacticturkey.co.nz for results. Normally their events have 3hr and 6hr options but they are threatening a longer event in Oct/Nov to prepare people for the NZ Championship 24hr rogaine in March. Check the Lactic Turkey website for up-to-date information.

Coming Events (Details in Event Calendar at www.rogaine.org.nz)

Wellington Shoestrings – organised by Orienteering HV.
A series of 3hr after-work events at two-weekly intervals beginning Thursday, 16th October. See the NZOF regaining website http://www.mapsport.co.nz/rog/rogevents.html for contact details.

Port Hills Twilight Rogaine – Wednesday 22nd October, 3hrs, Christchurch Port Hills
An after-work event organised by Chris Forne and friends in conjunction with NZRA. Details are available on our website, www.rogaine.org.nz .

Colonial Challenge – Saturday 22nd November, 10hr & 5hr events, Wellington.
Organised by Tony Gazley for Orienteering HV, this is the rebirth of the Colonial rogaine which was cancelled last April because of fire risk. See the NZOF rogaining website http://www.mapsport.co.nz/rog/rogevents.html for more details.

Heights of Korowai, Office Hours – Saturday 29th November, 7hrs, Eastern Canterbury High Country. This new event on the rogaining calendar is being organised by Grant Hunter for NZRA. It is still subject to DOC approval but we are hopeful it will go ahead. Check the website www.rogaine.org.nz regularly for updates. For further information contact Grant Hunter at g.hunter@clear.net.nz or phone (03) 351 6369.

Other Events

New Zealand Championship 2004 – 6 & 7th March, 24hrs, Waikato
Despite the championships being almost six months away it is not too soon to plan your participation. The Championship is the only "true" rogaine on the New Zealand calendar – "true" in the sense that it is a classical 24hr event run to official rogaining rules. NZRA and the Rogaining subcommittee of NZOF have agreed to alternate the organising of the Championship and it is NZOF's turn this time. Detailed information will be published on our website www.rogaine.org.nz in due course.

6th World Rogaining Championship – 8 & 9th May 2004, 24hrs, Arizona USA.
Anyone who wishes may compete in the World Championships – it is not restricted to elite representative athletes. Fifteen Kiwis competed in the 5th WRC held in Czech Republic at the end of July 2002, and a pairing of a Kiwi and an Aussie won the event. Why not plan a business trip or overseas vacation around this WRC? For more information see the event website at http://rogaine.tucsonorienteering.org/ . For one team's view on the Czech event see the report by Pete Squires at http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main_files/results/WRC2002Report.htm .

It is interesting to note that the 1st European Rogaining Championships were held in Russia in August. The sport that originated in Australia is steadily spreading.